BIRCH WILSON

Assignment 3 · Capability Mapping & Product Backlog

MET CS 634 — Agile Software Development

John LaCroix · April 2026

"Connecting Fans and Prospective Partners Alike in Unholy Harmony — The Birch Wilson Digital Experience"

SUMMARY

Birch Wilson launched a brand new website enabling fans, fellow artists, and music producers with one common goal: opportunity. An opportunity for fans to track their new favorite rock band before they go mainstream. An opportunity for aspiring producers to find that underground act that will push them to the next level.

PROBLEM

Underground artists are chronically undiscovered. Bloggers miss the window. Producers can't find the talent. The Birch Wilson Digital Experience solves the discovery problem — acting as both a discovery hub and a collaboration gateway.

SOLUTION

The site unifies the band's Spotify, Instagram, blog, contact, and show listings into a single branded digital home — giving every visitor exactly what they came for.

PERSONA 01

Dan the Hardcore Blogger

Age: 30 · Allston, MA · Freelance Writer & Underground Music Blogger

BACKGROUND

Dan works for a local underground music magazine. He bar-hops every night hunting for the next band nobody has heard of yet. He treasures the intimacy of small crowds and the purity of underground acts. He blogs about the bands he finds, building his reputation as a credible voice in the underground rock scene — always trying to get there first.

GOALS ON THE SITE

→ Discover Birch Wilson before they blow up

→ Gather raw material (bio, sound, story) to write about

→ Contribute a review to the Birch Wilson blog

→ Find upcoming shows to cover live

→ Build brand as a credible underground reviewer

"If there's a deep, unknown rock band out there, I will find it, and then I will tell their story!"

PERSONA 02

Jake the Indie Producer

West Springfield, MA · Ghost Hit Recording · Indie & Rock Specialist

BACKGROUND

Jake is a producer who specializes in finding local artists to record on a budget. A friendly introvert, he takes on indie and rock projects to build his client roster — with his eye on recording a smash hit that propels him to bigger acts. He actively scouts underground bands like Birch Wilson, looking for that next breakthrough project.

GOALS ON THE SITE

→ Assess Birch Wilson's sound and production readiness

→ Verify the band is active and gigging (not a dead project)

→ Understand the band's aesthetic and genre niche

→ Reach out directly with a recording pitch

→ Build his roster with credible underground acts

"If an indie band wants to make a record, I'll record them for a modest price."

Flow 1 · Dan Discovers the Band & Gathers Blog Material

Dan — Hardcore Blogger

CAPABILITY

Discover Birch Wilson & Gather Blogging Material

Trigger: Dan searches for underground rock bands to cover for his magazine

STEPS

STEP: Find the Site	STEP: Explore Band Identity	STEP: Listen to Music	STEP: Sign Up for Updates

ACTIVITIES

Find the Site	Explore Band Identity	Listen to Music	Sign Up for Updates
→ Search 'underground rock bands MA'	→ Read band bio & origin story on About page	→ Stream embedded Spotify tracks on Music page	→ Fill out email notification form
→ Click Birch Wilson in search results	→ Absorb visual aesthetic & artwork on Homepage	→ Read existing blog posts for context	→ Receive welcome confirmation with Spotify link

ENABLERS

SEO & search indexing | Spotify embed integration | Email / newsletter system | Blog CMS

NFRs

Discoverability | Page load performance | Usability | Mobile responsiveness

DATA

Band biography text | Spotify track metadata | Genre & influences info | Subscriber email list

Flow 2 · Dan Pitches a Blog Contribution

Dan — Hardcore Blogger

CAPABILITY

Submit a Blog Contribution Inquiry

Trigger: Dan wants to publish a review on the Birch Wilson site to build his reviewer brand

STEPS

STEP: Review Blog Content	STEP: Identify Opportunity	STEP: Submit Inquiry	STEP: Piece Published

ACTIVITIES

→ Navigate to Blog page	→ Find blog contribution call-to-action	→ Fill out contact form (name, email, pitch idea)	→ Band reviews & publishes Dan's piece
→ Read existing posts; assess tone & style	→ Review submission guidelines	→ Submit; receive auto-confirmation email	→ Dan shares on his blog & social feeds

ENABLERS

Blog CMS | Contact / inquiry form | Email notification system | Social share integration

NFRs

Usability | Reliability (form submission) | Content moderation | Accessibility

DATA

Existing blog posts | Form fields (name, email, pitch) | Auto-reply email template | Published article content

Flow 3 · Dan Attends a Show & Covers It Live

Dan — Hardcore Blogger

CAPABILITY

Discover, Reserve & Attend an Upcoming Show

Trigger: Dan wants to cover Birch Wilson live for his underground magazine

STEPS

STEP: Receive Notification	STEP: Review Show Details	STEP: Reserve Ticket	STEP: Attend & Cover

ACTIVITIES

→ Receive email alert for upcoming show	→ Read date, venue, and city	→ Fill out ticket reservation form	→ Attend show; experience intimate crowd
→ Click link; land on the Shows page	→ Confirm personal availability	→ Submit; receive confirmation email	→ Return post-show; access band photos & bio for review

ENABLERS

Email notification system | Shows / events listing | Ticket reservation form | Photo gallery

NFRs

Reliability | Timeliness (alerts before sellout) | Usability | Scalability

DATA

Show details (date, venue, city) | Ticket inventory | Fan email list | Live show photography

Flow 4 · Jake Scouts the Band & Assesses Their Sound

Jake — Indie Producer

CAPABILITY

Research & Evaluate Birch Wilson as a Recording Client

Trigger: Jake is searching for local indie/rock bands to record as his next project

STEPS

STEP: Discover the Site	STEP: Assess the Sound	STEP: Evaluate the Brand	STEP: Verify Band is Active

ACTIVITIES

→ Search 'indie rock band Massachusetts'	→ Navigate to Music page	→ Read About page; review bio & band history	→ Check Shows page for upcoming gig schedule
→ Find & click Birch Wilson in results	→ Listen to Spotify embeds; note production quality & style	→ Assess aesthetic fit for his studio niche	→ Confirm band is actively performing (not dormant)

ENABLERS

SEO & search indexing | Spotify embed | About / bio page | Shows / events listing

NFRs

Credibility (professional appearance) | Performance | Usability | Discoverability

DATA

Music track data | Band biography & history | Genre & influences metadata | Active show schedule

Flow 5 · Jake Reaches Out to Collaborate

Jake — Indie Producer

CAPABILITY

Submit a Recording Collaboration Inquiry

Trigger: Jake is ready to pitch a recording session to Birch Wilson

STEPS

STEP: Navigate to Contact	STEP: Complete Inquiry Form	STEP: Submit & Confirm	STEP: Begin Collaboration

ACTIVITIES

Navigate to Contact	Complete Inquiry Form	Submit & Confirm	Begin Collaboration
→ Find Contact page via site navigation	→ Enter name, studio, email & pitch details	→ Submit form; receive auto-confirmation email	→ Band reviews inquiry; sees credible producer
→ Review available contact options	→ Describe services and budget range	→ Inquiry logged for band review	→ Band responds; recording relationship begins

ENABLERS

Contact / inquiry form | Email notification system | Form validation | CMS for inquiry management

NFRs

Reliability | Security (form data protection) | Usability | Response time

DATA

Producer inquiry (name, studio, email, pitch) | Band contact email | Confirmation email template | Inquiry log

PRODUCT ROADMAP

Trello Board: [Insert Trello Board URL Here]

Release 1 Core Foundation	Release 2 Fan Engagement	Release 3 Community & Growth
→ Display band biography & story	→ Purchase / reserve show tickets on-site	→ Contribute fan / press review to blog
→ Embed Spotify music player	→ Read blog posts & band updates	→ Watch embedded video (live footage)
→ Link Instagram feed in footer	→ Browse live show photo gallery	→ Download band press kit / EPK
→ Submit booking / contact form	→ Auto-confirmation emails after submission	→ Browse limited merchandise store
→ View upcoming shows listing	→ Share pages to social platforms	→ View individual band member profiles
→ Sign up for email notifications	→ Welcome email with Spotify link on signup	→ Comment on blog posts
→ Display branding & artwork on Homepage		